



Northbridge Community Alliance

2025 Program Evaluation Summary

Published: January 2026

Overview

This summary presents key findings from Northbridge's 2025 program evaluation cycle. The evaluation includes participation data, survey feedback, and selected outcome indicators across Food Access, Tutoring & Youth Support, and Volunteer Engagement programs.

The purpose of this evaluation is to inform internal learning, strengthen program design, and support evidence-informed advocacy. Findings reflect documented program data and participant feedback collected during the 2025 calendar year.





Food Access Program

Participation & Reach

- 2,480 households received food assistance in 2025.
- 41% of participating households were located in Eastview.
- Pantry visits increased by 14% compared to 2024.
- 63% of participants reported accessing services more than once during the year.

Participant Feedback

Among surveyed pantry participants:

- 52% reported that Northbridge services helped them access food more consistently.
- 47% reported reduced reliance on emergency food sources after three months of participation.
- 38% reported improved access to culturally preferred food options.

Survey responses were voluntary and represent approximately 28% of participating households.

Interpretation

Participation trends indicate sustained and increasing demand for food assistance services. Self-reported feedback suggests perceived improvements in food consistency among participants; however, these findings are based on survey responses and do not establish causal impact.





Tutoring & Youth Support Programs

Participation & Coverage

- 312 middle school students participated in tutoring programs in 2025.
- 68% of participants were from Eastview and Riverbend combined.
- Average weekly attendance rate: 82%.
- Volunteer-to-student ratio improved from 1:4.8 (2024) to 1:4.3 (2025).

Outcome Indicators

Based on end-of-year surveys and academic partner feedback:

- 61% of participating students reported increased confidence in math or reading skills.
- 54% of surveyed families reported improved homework completion consistency.
- Partner schools noted improved engagement among regularly attending participants.

Northbridge does not collect standardized test data directly and does not claim that tutoring participation alone causes measurable academic performance improvements.





Volunteer Engagement

Volunteer Participation

- 428 active volunteers contributed services in 2025.
- Total volunteer hours: 11,640.
- 73% of youth-facing volunteers completed required certifications within two weeks of onboarding.
- Retention rate (12-month active volunteers): 64%.

Volunteer Feedback

From the 2025 Volunteer Engagement Survey:

- 81% reported satisfaction with their volunteer experience.
- 36% identified scheduling flexibility as the most significant barrier to continued participation.
- 29% cited onboarding clarity as an area for improvement.
- Survey response rate: 46% of active volunteers.

Cross-Program Observations

- Food access participation and tutoring enrollment both increased in Eastview compared to 2024.
- Programs with structured onboarding processes showed higher volunteer retention rates.
- Summer months corresponded with increased pantry utilization and reduced tutoring attendance.

These patterns reflect internal program tracking and may be influenced by external economic, seasonal, and community factors.





Evaluation Methods

The 2025 evaluation incorporated:

- Administrative participation data
- Pre- and post-program surveys
- Volunteer engagement surveys
- Partner organization feedback

Northbridge's evaluation methods prioritize transparency and learning. Data are collected through voluntary surveys and internal records and may not represent broader population-level conditions.

Limitations

- Survey findings are self-reported and subject to response bias.
- Participation data reflect individuals who engaged with Northbridge programs and may not capture unmet need.
- Northbridge does not conduct randomized controlled trials or longitudinal impact studies.
- Reported improvements represent participant perceptions unless otherwise specified.

Northbridge does not assert direct causal impact between its programs and long-term outcomes without formal evaluation evidence.

Alignment with Strategic Plan

Evaluation findings support ongoing implementation of the 2025–2028 Strategic Plan priorities:

- Increased food access participation aligns with Strategic Priority 1.
- Expanded tutoring participation aligns with Strategic Priority 2.
- Volunteer onboarding improvements align with Strategic Priority 3.

